

MMI 807 — DEVELOPMENT OF OPEN EDUCATION RESOURCES AND TOOLS**Module 10: Reporting and Submitting**

MSc in Mathematical Innovation • Open University of Kenya

1 MODULE OVERVIEW

This capstone module brings the entire MMI 807 journey to a professional conclusion. You will synthesise your experience across all nine previous modules into a complete, structured, and professionally written OER project report. This report is not merely a course submission — it is a professional document that could be shared with institutions, funders, the OER community, and future collaborators to communicate what you developed, why you developed it, how it was implemented, and what it achieved. Mastering this kind of professional reporting is an essential skill for any educator engaged in educational innovation.

LEARNING OUTCOMES — By the end of this module, you will be able to:

1. Define Open Educational Resources and articulate their principles, value, and limitations.
2. Identify the standard components of a professional OER project report.
3. Organise complex project information logically and coherently for a professional audience.
4. Apply formal academic and professional writing conventions appropriate for an OER report.
5. Integrate licensing, accessibility, and sustainability considerations into the final report.
6. Produce a complete, professionally structured draft OER project report.

2 THE OER PROJECT REPORT: STRUCTURE AND PURPOSE

2.1 1.1 Who Reads an OER Project Report?

An OER project report may be read by:

- **Institutional leadership** deciding whether to adopt, fund, or scale the OER.
- **Funders** evaluating whether the project delivered on its commitments.
- **The OER community** deciding whether to use, adapt, or build on the resource.
- **Researchers** documenting OER development practices and outcomes.
- **Future maintainers** taking over ongoing development.

Each audience has different needs. A well-structured report serves all of them by presenting information in a logical sequence from overview to detail, and by being honest about both achievements and limitations.

2.2 1.2 Standard Report Components

1	Cover Page	Title of OER, developer name, institutional affiliation, date, licence.
2	Executive Summary	300–500 words: problem, OER developed, key outcomes, recommendations. Written last; placed first.
3	Introduction / Background	The educational challenge addressed; evidence for the problem; context and stakeholders.
4	Objectives	Specific, measurable learning and development objectives. What was the OER designed to achieve?
5	OER Description	What was developed? Type, content, tools used, target audience, access route.
6	Methodology	How was it developed? OER landscape analysis, tool selection, design process, peer review, piloting.
7	Licensing and Accessibility	Licence applied; attribution; accessibility features; accessibility audit results.
8	Outcomes and Impact	What did the OER achieve? Learning outcome data; usage data; feedback summaries.
9	Challenges	Honest account of difficulties encountered; what did not work as planned.
10	Recommendations	What should be done next? For the OER itself; for wider adoption; for the development community.
11	Conclusion	Brief synthesis; significance of the contribution; future directions.
12	References	All sources cited, including OER sources (with URLs and licence information).
13	Appendices	Development log, pilot instruments, peer review records, accessibility checklist, CHANGELOG.

3 PROFESSIONAL WRITING CONVENTIONS

3.1 2.1 The Executive Summary

The executive summary is written last but read first. It must:

- State the educational problem in one or two sentences.
- Describe the OER developed and its key features.
- Summarise the key outcomes (with data where available).
- Make one or two clear recommendations.
- Stand alone: a reader who reads only the executive summary should understand what was done and what it achieved.

3.2 2.2 Writing Methodology Clearly

The methodology section is often the weakest in OER project reports. Common problems:

- **Vague descriptions:** “We used GeoGebra to create interactive resources” tells the reader almost nothing. Better: “We created six GeoGebra applets using GeoGebra Classic v6.0, each addressing one learning outcome from the KCSE Grade 12 calculus syllabus. Applets were designed following UDL principles and tested for offline functionality on Android 10.”
- **Missing rationale:** Describe not just what you did but why you chose each approach. Justify tool selection, licence choice, and pedagogical design decisions.
- **Missing verification:** Describe how you verified quality: peer review process, pilot design, feedback instruments used.

3.3 2.3 Reporting Outcomes Honestly

THE HONEST OUTCOMES PRINCIPLE

An OER project report is not a marketing document. Honest reporting of limited outcomes, implementation challenges, and unresolved problems is both professionally and ethically required. A report that claims uniform success while omitting the technical failures, the learners who could not access the content, and the teachers who found the resource too complex is a misleading document that undermines trust in the OER community.

The challenges section is not a confession of failure — it is evidence of reflective professional practice.

3.4 2.4 Licensing and Attribution in Reports

The report itself carries a licence. Choose deliberately:

- CC BY: Maximum openness. Encourages the community to build on and adapt the report itself.
- CC BY-SA: Open but requires derivatives to carry the same licence.
- Copyright (no CC): Significantly reduces the report’s utility for the OER community.

All images, diagrams, data tables, and quoted text from third-party sources in the report must be correctly attributed, with licence information.

4 SUSTAINABILITY: LOOKING BEYOND THE REPORT

4.1 3.1 Planning for OER Sustainability

The report should address not just what was achieved but how it will be sustained. Key sustainability considerations:

- **Platform sustainability:** Is the hosting platform (GitHub Pages, Moodle, OER Commons) likely to remain available long-term?
- **Maintenance:** Who will update the OER as the curriculum changes, technology evolves, or errors are identified?
- **Community:** Does the OER have a community of users who will flag issues and contribute improvements?
- **Version control:** Is the OER maintained in a version-controlled repository that enables future developers to continue from where you left off?
- **Institutional embedding:** Has the OER been adopted by an institution or curriculum authority in a way that ensures ongoing use?

5 DISCUSSION

FINAL REFLECTION DISCUSSION

In your final forum post for MMI 807, reflect on your journey from Module 1 to Module 10:

- What was the most significant challenge you experienced in developing your OER?
- Which section of your project report was most difficult to write, and why?
- How did the licensing framework (Creative Commons) influence your design decisions?
- What would you do differently if you were starting the project again today?
- What is one insight from this course that you will carry into your future professional practice?

Post 400–500 words and comment substantively on at least two colleagues' reflections.

6 MODULE 10 ASSIGNMENT: FINAL OER PROJECT REPORT

MODULE 10 ASSIGNMENT: COMPLETE OER PROJECT REPORT

Prepare a complete, professionally written OER project report based on your real or simulated development project from Modules 1–9. The report must follow the 13-section structure from Section 1.2 and meet the following requirements:

Required content:

- **Executive Summary** (300–500 words): Problem, OER developed, key outcomes, recommendations.
- **Introduction/Background** (400–600 words): Educational challenge with evidence; why OER is the appropriate response.
- **Objectives** (100–200 words): Specific, measurable development and learning objectives.
- **OER Description** (300–500 words): What was developed, its features, tools used, and access route.
- **Methodology** (600–900 words): OER landscape analysis, design process, peer review, piloting, with justification for each decision.
- **Licensing and Accessibility** (200–300 words): Licence choice and rationale; key accessibility features; accessibility audit summary.
- **Outcomes and Impact** (400–600 words): Evidence of achievement of objectives; usage data; learner feedback; learning outcome data where available.
- **Challenges** (200–300 words): Honest account of what did not go as planned and what you learned.
- **Recommendations** (200–300 words): Next steps for the OER and for wider adoption.
- **Conclusion** (100–200 words).
- **References**: All sources in a consistent academic referencing style (APA, Harvard, or equivalent).
- **Appendices**: Development log, peer review record, pilot report summary, accessibility checklist, and CHANGELOG.

Format: The report should be 3,500–5,000 words (excluding appendices). Submit as a PDF. The report itself should carry a Creative Commons licence, stated on the cover page.

7 KEY CONCEPTS AND TERMINOLOGY

Executive Summary	A concise standalone summary of a report's purpose, findings, and recommendations, written last but positioned first.
Methodology	The section of a project report describing and justifying the processes, tools, and decisions used to develop the OER.
Sustainability Plan	A documented strategy for maintaining, updating, and ensuring the continued availability and relevance of an OER after the initial development project ends.
CHANGELOG	A human-readable file documenting all notable changes between versions of an OER, following a standard format.
Attribution	The formal crediting of all sources, contributors, and third-party content used in an OER, using the TASL format for Creative Commons content.

MODULE 10 SUMMARY — AND COURSE CLOSING REFLECTION

Module 10:

- A professional OER project report has 13 components: cover page, executive summary, introduction, objectives, OER description, methodology, licensing/accessibility, outcomes, challenges, recommendations, conclusion, references, and appendices.
- The executive summary stands alone: it gives a complete picture of the project in 300–500 words for readers who will go no further.
- Honest reporting of challenges and limitations is professionally and ethically required. It builds community trust and enables others to learn from your experience.
- The report itself carries a licence: choosing CC BY signals commitment to the OER community's norms of openness.
- Sustainability planning — addressing platform, maintenance, community, version control, and institutional embedding — transforms a project deliverable into a lasting contribution.

Course Closing Reflection:

MMI 807 has taken you from identifying a challenge in mathematics education to producing a professionally documented, piloted, and reported OER. Along the way, you have developed skills in legal literacy (Creative Commons licences), technical authoring (GeoGebra, STACK, PreTeXt, GitHub), inclusive design (UDL, WCAG, cultural responsiveness), peer review, diffusion theory, pilot evaluation, and professional reporting.

These are not merely academic skills. They are the capabilities that enable mathematics educators to become *creators* of the educational infrastructure their students need — not just consumers of what commercial publishers choose to provide.

The most important insight from this course cannot be found in any module or framework: it is the experience of taking a problem that you have personally witnessed, and building a resource that genuinely helps. That experience — of moving from “this is a problem” to “here is something that helps” — is what this course has been preparing you for.

Apply the principles of open education resource development, remixing, and structured documentation to bring sustainable innovation into your mathematics teaching context. The learners who will benefit from your OER are waiting.

8 FURTHER READING AND COURSE RESOURCES

- UNESCO (2019). *Recommendation on Open Educational Resources*. <https://en.unesco.org/oer>
- White Paper: Seven Recommendations to Improve OER Uptake.
- Hollow, D. (2014). *Evaluating ICT in Education: A Guide for Decision Makers*. DFID / R4D.
- Rogers, E. M. (2003). *Diffusion of Innovations* (5th ed.). Free Press.
- Keep a Changelog: <https://keepachangelog.com>
- Creative Commons Licence Chooser: <https://chooser-beta.creativecommons.org>
- GitHub Documentation: <https://docs.github.com>